

# Productivity

This chapter will look at freeware tools that will help you get things done at work. In these times of recession, when most people are worried about job security, and some companies have frozen hiring, it's even more important that you, your colleagues or your team get more done, and quicker.

## 8.1 Chandler 1.0.3 (ToDo Software)

Chandler ([chandlerproject.org](http://chandlerproject.org)) is like the Swiss army knife of productivity software. Its list of features is exhaustive, and after using it, you will soon start wondering how you ever did without it.

First, a little history: Mitchell Kapor, the founder of Lotus Development (later, Lotus Software), the guys who made the Lotus 1-2-3 spreadsheet, and for all practical purposes, the guys who made us all want to own a PC back in the mid-80s, is the man who started the Chandler project. The dream was to make an Open Source Applications Foundation, which Kapor did, and aimed to end the tyranny of Microsoft's Outlook and Exchange, which Chandler didn't. If you look at the goals the developers set themselves, the project is an utter failure, but if you use Chandler, you'll realise that it's actually useful. Kapor no longer funds the project however, which some say cost over \$8 million to reach version 1.0. Currently, like any other Open Source project, chandler is hoping to become popular enough to form a large community of developers and users, so that it can better itself. Make sure to try it out once, to show your support.

Back to Chandler, it's not the easiest of interfaces to get used to, but it doesn't take very long, so stick with it.

The main window has 4 panes - a quick selection, calendar, notes panel and a task scheduler. There's also a bar on the top that has a quick entry field that will let you add notes in a jiffy.